

Environment

Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
Verbs	**The Environment**
Regular and Irregular Verbs	Discussing environmental issues
Pronunciation of -ED	Endangered Species
Present Perfect Simple	Protected Species
Present Perfect Continuous	
Comparison: Present Continuous and Present Perfect Continuous	
Comparison: Present Perfect Continuous and Present Perfect Simple	

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The Top 10 environmental issues that should make you worry

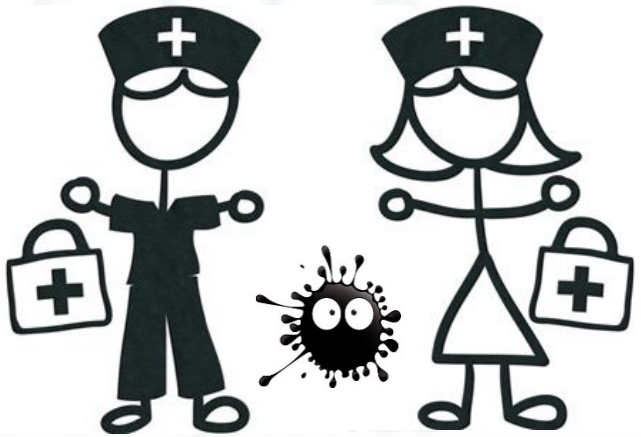
Over the years, the environment has been changing, and not for the better.
Here is a list of the current top environmental issues you should be concerned about.

10. Public health
9. Land management and urbanisation
8. Waste disposal
7. Overpopulation
6. Loss of biodiversity
5. Water scarcity and water pollution
4. Pollution
3. Deforestation
2. Ecosystems and endangered species
1. Climate change



10. Public health

Many of the issues we face are related to public health. Pollution, water scarcity and overpopulation all present a clear danger to public health. Nearly 25 percent of all deaths each year are directly caused by unhealthy environments, according to the World Health Organisation.



Even in developed countries, the growing anti-vaccination movement threatens public health, causing diseases that were almost completely eradicated, like measles (MORBILLO), to reappear.

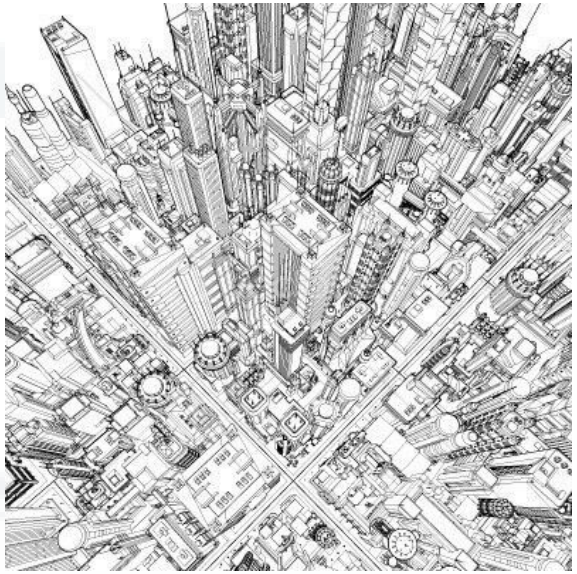
The health and wellness of human beings is extremely important. What people eat, drink and breathe in is essential for their well-being. Polluted air and water are an escalating crisis we need to resolve as soon as possible.

9. Land management and urbanisation

The uncontrolled expansion of urban areas, is a modern problem that is threatening (STA MINACCIANDO) the environment.

Contractors (IMPRENDITORI EDILI) continue building housing developments (ZONE RESIDENZIALI) in record time, and undeveloped land is becoming scarce. Covering the landscape with concrete interrupts the natural water cycle, preventing rainwater from soaking into the ground.





With less natural land, the environment is greatly damaged.
More houses lead to more pollution. Buildings emit their gasses into the air, which affects the health of the environment.

It's time to put natural habitats first. We need to preserve land, stop building, and start restoring.

8. Waste disposal

Waste disposal is a threat to not only the Earth and its environment, but to humans as well.



It's easy to throw something in a trash bin. We don't usually think about our local landfills (DISCARICHE) except to complain about the smell when we drive by them, but the average person generates about 10 kg of trash each day.

This trash ends up in two places, either in landfills, or in natural habitats and in the ocean. When waste is dumped in the ocean, the marine animals often mistake it for food or get tangled up in it, and die.



When waste is disposed of by burning, it emits hazardous toxins in the air, which people breathe in, frequently causing cancer.

People can limit this crisis by reducing the amount of waste they produce, by using products that can be recycled or discarded in a compost pile.

7. Overpopulation

We have more than seven billion people on the planet right now – and that number is expected to reach 9.7 billion by 2050, and 11.2 billion by 2100.

We live on a planet that can only support about 10 billion people, which means we're less than a century away from overpopulation becoming a serious and even life-threatening problem.

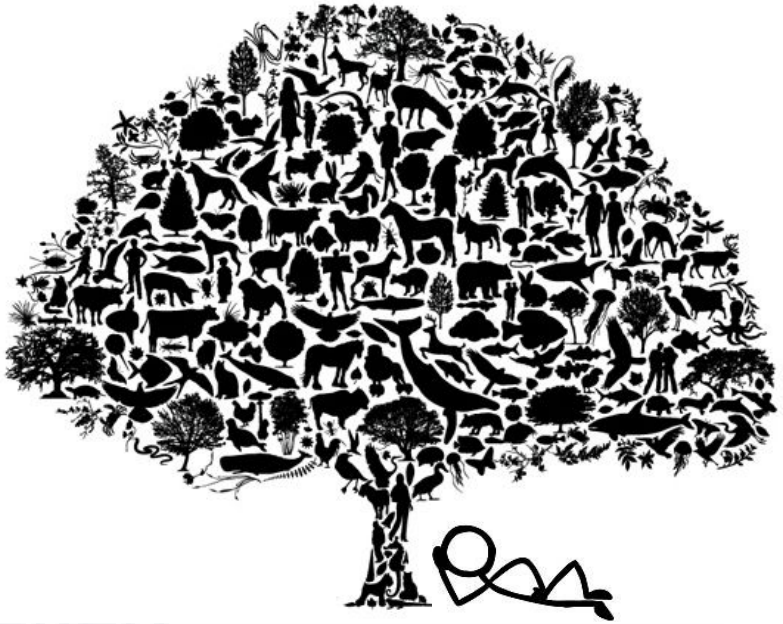


As the world's population rises, the amount of resources available for survival decreases. And the more people there are on the planet, the more they release carbon dioxide and other gasses into the air, increasing the greenhouse effect.

Fortunately, renewable energy sources are a great way to fight carbon emissions. By increasing the use of sustainable energy sources, such as wind power and solar power, we can start reducing carbon emissions, decreasing the greenhouse effect and helping our planet – and ourselves - breathe.

6. Loss of biodiversity

Biodiversity, or the variety of life in the world or a particular ecosystem, is declining. The levels of biodiversity across the world have significantly lowered to a dangerous amount. According to the World Wildlife Federation, biodiversity has declined by 30 percent since 1970.



Biodiversity is in critical condition due to various threats, including urbanisation, deforestation and climate change.

The lack of biodiversity puts the food chain, water sources and other resources at risk. Without enough biodiversity, ecosystems deteriorate until they no longer exist.

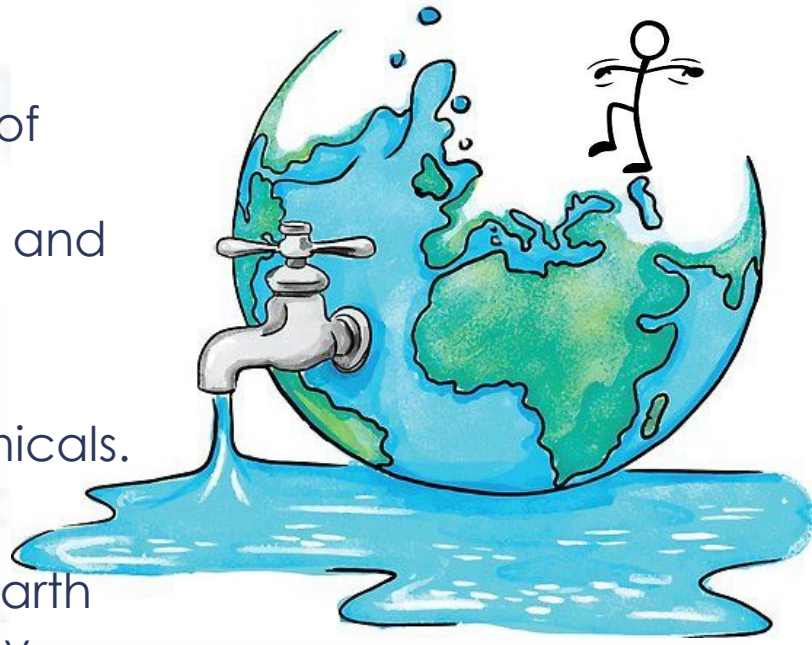
Education and protection are key to conserve biodiversity.
Think with a sustainable mind. Make green choices. Tell the world before it's too late.

5. Water scarcity and water pollution

A big problem today is water scarcity. There is a big difference between water and fresh, clean water. Saltwater, freshwater, groundwater and surface water are the essential sources of water.

There are two ways water can be scarce: the lack of water and the lack of drinkable water.
We often take the water coming out of the tap for granted - we turn it on and water flows - but that's not the case in many places around the world.

Drinkable water can become contaminated with things such as airborne diseases (MALATTIE TRASPORTATE DALL'ARIA), toxins, and hazardous chemicals. An estimated 780 million people have no access to clean water at all.



Like the Earth, your body is made up of about 70 percent of water. Both Earth and your body need clean water to survive. You can do your part. Start by turning the water off while brushing your teeth or while lathering up (INSAPONARSI) in the shower. You're not just saving the fish - you're saving the world.

4. Pollution



Pollution comes in many forms. Air, soil, and water are all polluted, and pollution poses current and future threats to humans and the environment.

Contaminated waters are undrinkable. Polluted air weakens the ozone layer and causes health problems. Contaminated soil destroys habitats and cultivations.

As a human, your body is affected by pollution because it's in the air you breathe and in the water you drink. It is one of the biggest killers on the planet, as it kills over 100 million people each year, not to mention animals and plants.

We dump millions of tons of garbage and trillions of hectolitres of untreated sewage and contaminated water into the oceans and rivers, every single year.

In order to see renewed air, water, and soil, it's essential to recover from pollution, by caring for the ecosystems, making sustainable choices and limiting the number of resources used.

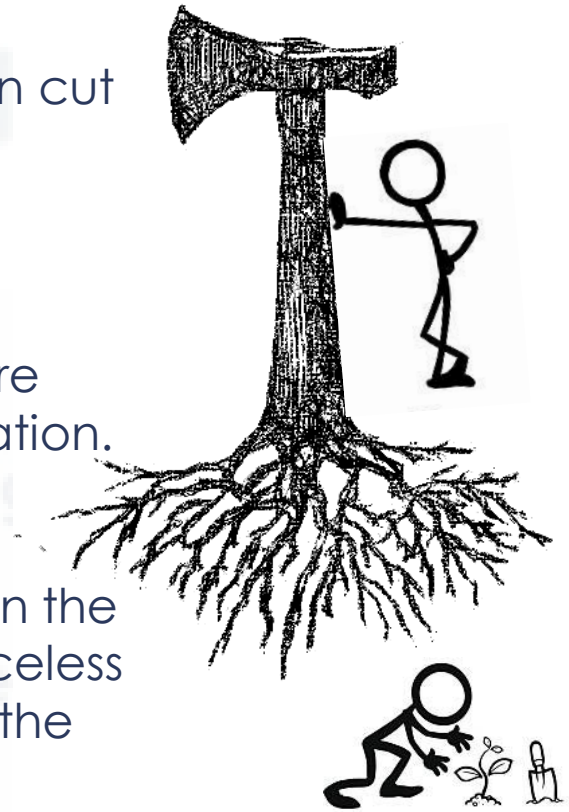
3. Deforestation

At least 15 percent of greenhouse gas emissions don't come from cars or factories - they come from deforestation.

By 2030, we may only have 10 percent of the rainforests left - the rest will have been cut down for wood or wood pulp products, or cleared for agricultural uses.
In addition to this, over 70 percent of the planet's plant and animal species live in forests.

Species lose their habitats. Ecosystems die out. Climate change continues. There are fewer trees to produce oxygen and absorb carbon dioxide. It's all due to deforestation. One of the areas where deforestation is most intense, is the Amazon rainforest.

The Amazon rainforest is one of the most important and least known natural areas in the world, an almost intact kingdom, rich in biodiversity, hydrological systems. It is a priceless natural heritage, and our very existence depends on it. It is considered the lung of the Earth, and if it disappears there will be no future.



2. Ecosystems and endangered species

Due to the list of environmental issues happening to this planet, both ecosystems and species are affected.



It is estimated that 1 out of 10 species will be extinct by 2050. The endangered species list continues to grow as ecosystems continue to decrease. Lost habitats mean losing the species that live there. While some may be able to migrate elsewhere, others will not be able to.

With the rising temperatures of the Arctic, for example, sea ice melts, which eliminates the habitat of polar bears. The list of endangered species includes many other animals as well, such as the orangutan, the black rhino, the giant panda and the green turtle.



The best way to save species is to support organisations, such as WWF, dedicated to fighting species' extinction. By supporting the cause, you're helping combat the issue. You can also find laws and government acts available to sign that protect ecosystems and endangered species.

1. Climate change

Unfortunately, the climate change debate continues, despite decades of research on the subject. Climate change is here, and it is happening. 97 percent of scientists who study the climate agree that greenhouse gasses, both natural and those created by humans, are the main cause.

Global temperatures are rising, icecaps are melting, and droughts, wildfires, and super hurricanes are causing serious damage. Not only is the Earth's temperature continuing to rise, but the sea levels are rising, too. Both the ocean and the Earth are growing warmer.

Greenhouse gasses are a leading cause of climate change, specifically those emitted from the human population. This has an impact on habitats, agriculture, the ocean and natural disasters.

The best way to reduce climate change is to build sustainably. Using renewable energy sources such as solar and wind power will assist the fight against climate change. Limiting waste and pollution will help preserve the environment.

